TRAVELSCOUT · PROJECT DOCUMENT

User research plan and template

A ready-to-run plan for learning how groups plan trips today. Findings stay empty until sessions happen.

PROJECT	PREPARED BY	VERSION
TravelScout	Aditi Kela, product lead	1.0, draft for review

DATE

October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure

PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

> No research findings exist yet for this project, so none are written here. TO CONFIRM

Goals

- Understand how groups of friends or family plan a trip today.
- Find where planning breaks down: choosing dates, budget, places, food, who pays.
- Test whether sourced, dated price estimates build trust.
- Learn whether an AI guide in the group chat is welcome.

Research questions

#	QUESTION	DECISION IT INFORMS
RQ1	Which tools do groups use, and where does it go wrong?	Which tabs matter most
RQ2	How do groups decide (polls, one organizer, long threads)?	Poll design
RQ3	How much do travelers trust AI-suggested prices and plans?	Source and date display
RQ4	How do dietary needs and pace differences get handled?	Preference form
RQ5	How is money handled during and after a trip?	Expenses depth

Method

METHOD	SAMPLE	LENGTH
Interview	8 people who planned a group trip in the last year	30 minutes

METHOD	SAMPLE	LENGTH
Group test	3 groups of 3 to 6 who are planning a real or mock trip	45 minutes
Survey	30 or more responses	4 minutes

> Sample sizes are my proposal. PROPOSED

Screener

1. Have you planned or joined a trip with 3 or more people in the past 12 months?
2. Who organized it, and how many people went?
3. Which tools did you use?
4. Do you or anyone in your group have dietary or accessibility needs that affect planning?
5. Are you comfortable being recorded for notes?

Interview guide (30 minutes)

TIME	PROMPTS
0:00	Opening, consent, "Tell me about your last group trip."
0:05	"How did the idea turn into a plan?" "Where did people disagree?" "What did you wish you had earlier?"
0:13	"How did you pick flights and stays?" "How did you know prices were current?" "Did price change after you decided?"
0:20	"How did you handle food and accessibility needs?" "How did you split costs?"
0:25	"Would you let an AI suggest options in your group chat? What would make you trust it?"
0:28	Wrap-up and thanks.

Group test script (45 minutes)

1. Organizer creates a trip with destination, dates, travelers and budget.
2. Others join with the code and fill their preferences.
3. The group asks the guide for flights and stays; ask them to decide whether to trust each price.
4. The group creates one poll and picks the winner.
5. They add two items to the itinerary and check the weather.
6. Debrief: "What was confusing?" "What would you use again?"

Measures

MEASURE	HOW
Time to join	Seconds from code entry to preferences saved
Trust in prices (1 to 5)	Ask after the guide shows estimates
Polls used	Count of poll votes
Task success	Completed without help (yes/no)

MEASURE	HOW
Would use again (yes/no)	Debrief

Survey (10 questions)

1. How many group trips in the last year?
2. Group size.
3. Tools used for planning (multi-select).
4. Biggest planning frustration (open).
5. How do you decide (poll, one person decides, discussion)?
6. How do you check price accuracy?
7. Would you trust an AI-suggested price with a date and source? (1 to 5)
8. Do you or your group have dietary or accessibility needs?
9. How do you split expenses?
0. Would you use a shared planning room? (yes/maybe/no; why)

Consent and care

- Explain recording and storage; use participant codes.
- Do not ask for passport, payment or booking details.
- Delete recordings after synthesis.

Note-taking template

PARTICIPANT	DATE	GROUP SIZE	QUOTE	OBSERVATION	THEME	NEED OR PAIN
P01						
P02						

Synthesis

1. Notes to affinity groups.
2. Name themes as sentences.
3. Count participants per theme; 3 or more is a pattern.
4. Turn patterns into insights and changes to scope.

Findings log (complete after sessions)

THEME	PARTICIPANTS	EVIDENCE	INSIGHT	CHANGE

Schedule

WEEK	ACTIVITY
1	Recruit, finalize guide, pilot once
2	Interviews and group tests

WEEK	ACTIVITY
3	Survey, synthesis, report